

3.1.2 Area of study 1 – Set plays

Students must study and explore practically **two** set plays, one chosen from List A and one chosen from List B.

There are three prohibited play combinations for the exam: students must not answer on both Butterworth's *Jerusalem* from List A and Teale's *Brontë*, Gurira's *The Convert*, or Ellams' *Three Sisters* from List B. This is because these texts were written at a similar time.

Study should be targeted at developing ideas for how the plays chosen may be interpreted and performed.

For plays in List A, for the purposes of the exam students must be prepared to adopt the perspective of at least two of the following three roles:

- performer
- designer (lighting, sound, set and costume)
- director.

For plays in List B, for the purposes of the exam students must be prepared to adopt the perspective of director, performer and designer (lighting, sound, set, costume).

Students must also develop [Knowledge and understanding](#) (page 11) of the content listed, in particular:

- how the play has been constructed to be performed and to communicate meaning
- how the play is informed by its social, cultural and historical context.

Students must not answer Section A or Section B of the exam on the same play they answer on for Section C ie the live production seen cannot be one of their set plays.

3.1.2.1 List A

Specific editions are not prescribed for these plays. However, we've listed the editions we use to set questions.

If you wish to use a different edition, we recommend you source a copy of the one we use to make sure it's similar. This will enable your students to access the questions on the paper. Adaptations are not appropriate.

List A – these plays have been selected to represent significant drama through the ages.

Playwright	List A set play
Sophocles	<i>Antigone</i> (<i>The Three Theban Plays</i> , translated by Robert Fagles, Penguin, 1984, ISBN: 0140444254)
William Shakespeare	<i>Much Ado About Nothing</i> (ed Claire McEachern, Bloomsbury Arden Shakespeare, 2016, ISBN: 1472520297)
Carlo Goldoni	<i>A Servant to Two Masters</i> (ed Lee Hall, Methuen Drama, 1999, ISBN 0413748502)
Henrik Ibsen	<i>Hedda Gabler</i> (Student Edition, Bloomsbury, 2002, ISBN: 0413770702)
Bertolt Brecht	<i>The Caucasian Chalk Circle</i> (ed Eric Bentley, Penguin, 2007, ISBN: 0141189169)
Dario Fo	<i>Accidental Death of an Anarchist</i> (Methuen Drama, 1987, ISBN: 0413156109)
Jez Butterworth	<i>Jerusalem</i> (Nick Hern Books, 2009, ISBN: 1848420501)

3.1.2.2 List B

These plays have been selected to represent 20th and 21st century drama.

Specific editions are prescribed for these plays.

Playwright	List B set play
Federico García Lorca	<i>Yerma</i> (Methuen Drama, 2007, ISBN: 978-0713683264)
Tennessee Williams	<i>The Glass Menagerie</i> (Penguin, 2009, ISBN: 978-0141190266)
Steven Berkoff	<i>Metamorphosis</i> (in <i>Three Theatre Adaptations from Franz Kafka</i> , Amber Lane Press, 1988, ISBN: 978-0906399842)
Caryl Churchill	<i>Cloud Nine</i> (in <i>Plays: 1</i> , Methuen Drama, ISBN: 978-0413566706)
Timberlake Wertenbaker	<i>Our Country's Good</i> (Methuen Student Editions, ISBN: 978-1350097889)
Polly Teale	<i>Brontë</i> (Polly Teale, Nick Hern Books, 2011, ISBN: 978-1848421707)
Danai Gurira	<i>The Convert</i> (Methuen Drama, 2022, ISBN: 9781350340879)
Inua Ellams	<i>Three Sisters (A new play after Chekhov)</i> (Methuen Drama, ISBN: 978-1-35026278-2)